

enough to get your employer contributions is a great idea, as soon as you start work.

I previously talked about investing as a way of growing wealth – but even if you’ve never heard of a stocks and shares ISA, you are most likely an investor already, through your pension. If you’ve ever paid into your company pension scheme, and it is now compulsory for your employer to do so, it’s likely that your money is being invested to create your pension fund. It’s important to know this, because when something is automatically deducted from your salary each month, you feel less connected with that money. It’s like the tax that you pay as an employee, which you never see in your bank account. This is good, because you don’t miss it or risk spending it, but it can also mean that you’re missing an opportunity to really make the most of your pension, or even to ensure that your pension investments aren’t in direct conflict with your personal beliefs and values, as I discussed earlier in this step. Taking an active interest in your pension and knowing how much you’re contributing, as well as making sure that you are maximizing your employer contributions (if you’re employed by a company), will really enhance those feelings of security and freedom that we’ve established as being vital for financial wellbeing.

If you’re self-employed, the bad news is that there’s nobody else to contribute to your pension – it’s all you. But the good news is that it’s super easy to get started with your pension using any number of fintech providers. A simple SIPP (Self-Invested Personal Pension) can take minutes to set up, and you